

# Validation Purpose Identification Module (VPIM)

**Architecture Ecosystem:** Structured Reality Standards™

**Architecture Family:** VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture

**Parent Standard:** Validation Purpose & Scope Standard (VPSS)

**Operational Layer:** Validation Purpose & Scope Governance Layer

**Category:** AI & Interpretation

**Subcategory:** Validation Governance

**Type:** Parent Standard Module

**Governed Space:** Validation Purpose Identification

**Version:** 1.0

**Status:** Canonical · Open Module

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**Compatibility:** OOF® Methodology OS™ · GOA™ · OBIDENTITY® · INTEGROS®  
· ORA™ · AGA™ · AIG® · CLIA® · MGIA™ · ASGA™ · RIS™

**AI-Readable:** Yes

**Authority:** OOF®

**Protection:** MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

**Canonical Language:** English (UCL™)

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## Governed Space

Validation Purpose Identification

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## Canonical Definition

**Validation Purpose Identification Module (VPIM)** defines the governance framework for identifying, articulating, distinguishing, documenting, and maintaining the specific purpose for which validation of an established Validation Object is required.

It establishes the conditions necessary to ensure that every governed validation begins with an explicit validation purpose capable of directing subsequent scope, depth, applicability, criteria, methodology, evidence, execution, determination, state, and reliance governance.

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## Operational Role

VPIM governs the purpose-identification layer of Validation Purpose & Scope governance.

Its role is to transform a general request, requirement, concern, decision need, operational need, regulatory obligation, or other validation trigger into an explicit and governable

**Validation Purpose.**

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VPIM ensures that validation is not initiated merely because validation is possible.

It must be possible to determine **why validation is necessary and what governance need it is intended to address.**

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## Module Operational Space

VPIM governs:

- validation-purpose identification,
  - validation-purpose articulation,
  - validation-purpose differentiation,
  - validation objectives,
  - intended validation use,
  - validation triggers,
  - validation-purpose justification,
  - purpose ambiguity,
  - competing validation purposes,
  - purpose changes,
  - purpose traceability,
  - and validation-purpose continuity.
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## Module Function

VPIM applies whenever an established Validation Object is proposed or required for validation.

Its function is to prevent:

- validation without a defined purpose,
  - vague validation objectives,
  - incompatible purposes being treated as one validation requirement,
  - technical activity being mistaken for validation purpose,
  - validation designed for one purpose being represented as supporting another,
  - undocumented purpose changes,
  - and validation conclusions being detached from the governance need that originally justified validation.
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## Validation Purpose Identification

A Validation Purpose should establish the governance reason for which validation is being performed.

A purpose may arise from:

- operational deployment,
  - reliance requirements,
  - decision support,
  - regulatory obligations,
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- compliance requirements,
- assurance requirements,
- risk conditions,
- system change,
- model change,
- object change,
- incident response,
- procurement or adoption decisions,
- certification or qualification requirements,
- governance review,
- or another legitimate validation need.

The existence of a trigger does not itself define the Validation Purpose.

VPIM requires the underlying governance objective to be made explicit.

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## Purpose and Objective Distinction

VPIM distinguishes between the broader **Validation Purpose** and the specific **Validation Objective**.

The Validation Purpose explains:

### Why is validation required?

The Validation Objective explains:

### What must this validation establish in order to satisfy that purpose?

For example:

**Purpose:** determine whether an AI system can support a defined operational deployment.

**Objective:** establish whether the system satisfies the validation conditions required for that deployment environment.

This distinction creates a clearer basis for subsequent validation scope and criteria.

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## Purpose Specificity

A Validation Purpose must be sufficiently specific to guide subsequent governance.

Statements such as:

- "validate the system," "check the model," "confirm quality," or "make sure it works"

may describe an intention to perform validation but do not necessarily establish a sufficiently governed Validation Purpose.

VPIM requires sufficient specificity to determine what governance need the validation is expected to satisfy.

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## Multiple Validation Purposes

A single Validation Object may have multiple legitimate Validation Purposes.

For example, the same AI system may require validation for:

- internal deployment,
- regulatory compliance,
- safety-critical use,
- customer reliance,
- model modification,
- or transfer into a new operational environment.

VPIM requires materially different purposes to remain distinguishable.

Where multiple purposes can legitimately share a validation process, their relationship should be documented.

Where they require materially different scope, depth, criteria, methodology, or evidence, they should not be collapsed into a single ambiguous purpose.

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## Minimum Implementation Framework

### 1. Identify the Validation Trigger

Determine what event, requirement, decision, change, obligation, or governance need initiated validation.

### 2. Establish the Validation Purpose

Define why validation is required and which governance need it is intended to address.

### 3. Establish the Validation Objective

Determine what validation must establish for the identified purpose to be meaningfully satisfied.

### 4. Assess Purpose Clarity

Determine whether the purpose is sufficiently explicit to guide subsequent:

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- scope,
- depth,
- applicability,
- criteria,
- methodology,
- evidence requirements,
- and validation determination.

## 5. Preserve Purpose Traceability

Maintain:

- validation trigger,
- purpose statement,
- validation objective,
- intended use,
- purpose justification,
- relevant authority or requirement references,
- purpose changes,
- timestamps,
- and sufficient traceability throughout the validation lifecycle.

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## Purpose Change Governance

The Validation Purpose may change after validation has begun.

A purpose change may be material where it alters:

- the intended use of validation,
- the decision validation is expected to support,
- the required scope,
- the required depth,
- validation criteria,
- methodology,
- evidence requirements,
- applicability,
- or eventual reliance.

Material purpose change must therefore be recognized and governed rather than silently absorbed into the existing validation process.

Where necessary, subsequent validation activities must be reassessed against the modified purpose.

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## Purpose–Object Alignment

The identified Validation Purpose must be applicable to the established Validation Object.

A valid governance purpose cannot compensate for an incorrectly identified object.

Similarly, a precisely established object does not justify a validation process whose purpose remains unclear.

VPIM therefore maintains explicit alignment between:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose → Validation Objective**

before detailed validation scope is established.

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## Use Case 1 — AI Deployment Validation

### Scenario

An organization intends to deploy an AI model within a customer-facing decision-support environment and requests that the model be "validated."

### Application

VPIM identifies the deployment decision as the validation trigger and establishes the purpose as determining whether the model can support the defined operational use under governed conditions.

The corresponding objective establishes what the validation must demonstrate to support that deployment purpose.

### Result

Subsequent validation governance is designed around a specific operational purpose rather than an undefined request to "validate the AI."

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## Use Case 2 — Regulatory Validation Requirement

### Scenario

A regulated organization receives a requirement to demonstrate that a critical analytical process has undergone validation.

### Application

VPIM distinguishes the regulatory trigger from the Validation Purpose and identifies the governance objective that the validation must satisfy.

### Result

The validation process can subsequently establish a scope, depth, criteria, and evidence structure directly connected to the actual regulatory validation need rather than merely documenting that

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## Canonical Closing Statement

**Validation Purpose Identification Module establishes the canonical governance framework for determining why validation is required before its scope, depth, criteria, methodology, evidence, or execution are defined. By governing validation triggers, purpose articulation, objectives, intended use, purpose differentiation, change, and traceability, VPIM ensures that every governed validation begins with an explicit reason and remains connected to the governance need it was created to satisfy.**

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## Parent Resources

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

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## Internal Module Flow

[→ Next module: Validation Scope Definition Module \(VSCDM\)](#)

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## Related Documents

[→ Validation Purpose & Scope Standard](#)

[→ About Validation Purpose & Scope Standard](#)

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## Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>